

Northwestern Mutual

Contrast Requirements (WCAG 2.1, AA)

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Northwestern Mutual adheres to WCAG 2.0 accessibility standards across all digital experiences.

WCAG 2.1 requirements for text

The visual presentation of [text](#) and [images of text](#) has a [contrast ratio](#) of at least 4.5:1.

Exceptions:

Large Text

[Large-scale](#) text and images of large-scale text have a contrast ratio of at least 3:1.

Incidental

Text or images of text that are part of an inactive [user interface component](#), that are [pure decoration](#), that are not visible to anyone, or that are part of a picture that contains significant other visual content, have no contrast requirement.

Logotypes

Text that is part of a logo or brand name has no contrast requirement.

Useful Links

[WCAG 2.1 text contrast requirements](#)

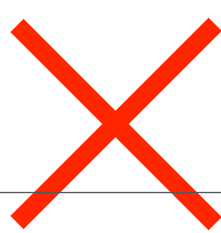
[Full WCAG 2.1 documentation](#)

[Web accessibility for designers](#)

[Quick contrast checker](#)

Best Practices: Text over solid backgrounds*

Any text that communicates meaning must have a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 with the background color.



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*NOTE: examples shown do not represent all possible color combinations.
Please see [WCAG 2.1 contrast requirements](#) and use [ADA checker](#) to verify specific use cases.

Best Practices: Text over photographic backgrounds*

Any text that communicates meaning must have a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 with photographic backgrounds (or 3:1 for large text). It is generally difficult to achieve this standard consistently over photographic backgrounds due to tonal variance, as well as fluctuations in responsive text positioning. While contrast in some areas of the photo may be sufficient, it may be lacking in others.



*NOTE: examples shown do not represent all possible color combinations.

Please see [WCAG 2.1 contrast requirements](#) and use [ADA checker](#) to verify specific use cases.

WCAG 2.1 requirements for user interface components

WCAG 2.1 requires a contrast ratio of at least 3:1 for user interface components (e.g. as form input borders and interface controls).

Useful Links

[WCAG 2.1 non-text contrast requirements](#)

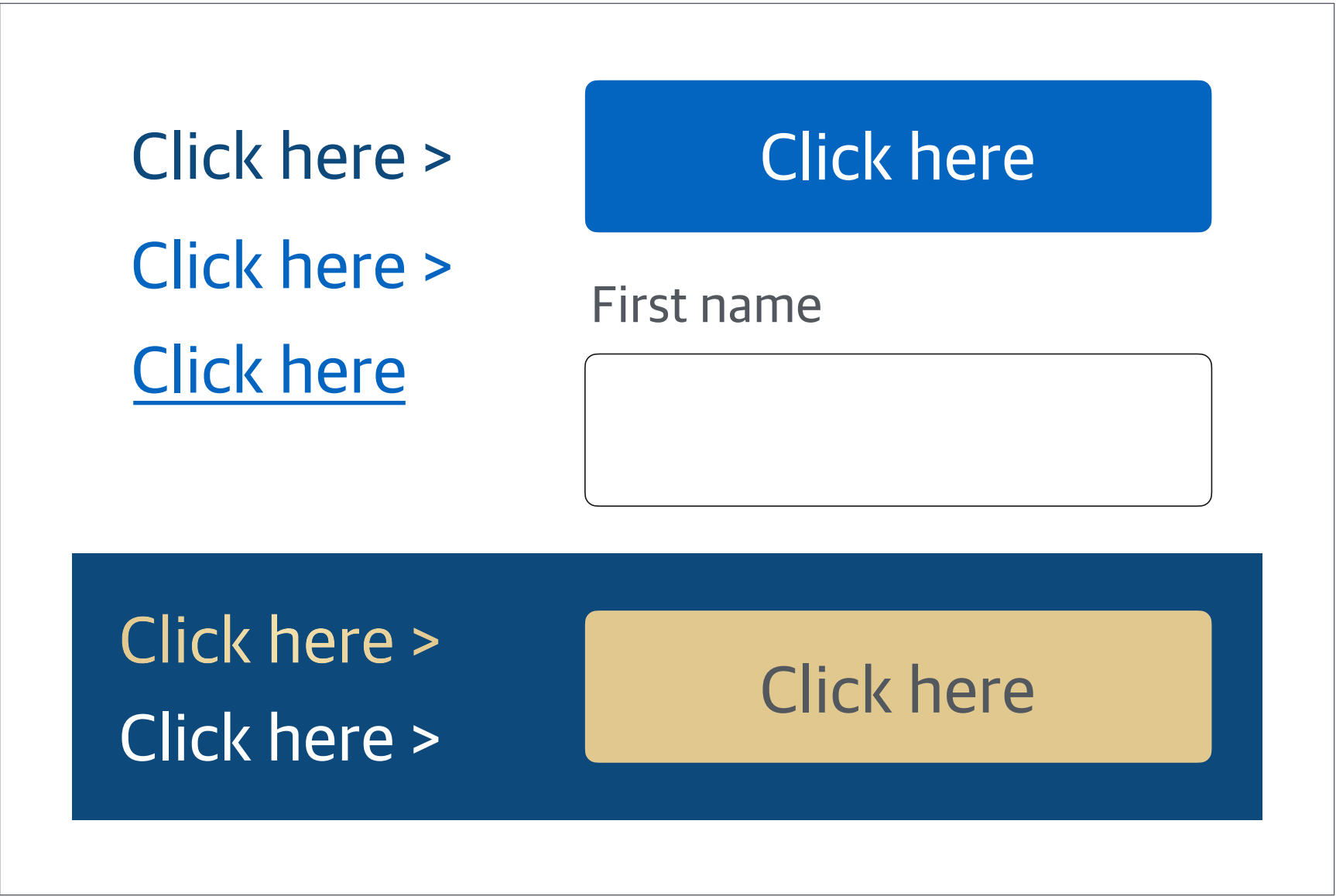
[Full WCAG 2.1 documentation](#)

[Web accessibility for designers](#)

[**Quick contrast checker**](#)

Best Practices: User interface components*

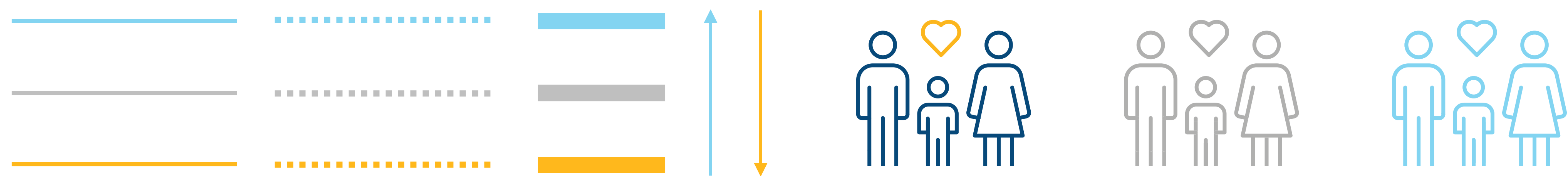
Text used within interactive components must have a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 and graphic interactive elements (e.g. as form input borders) a contrast ratio of at least 3:1.



*NOTE: examples shown do not represent all possible color combinations.
Please see [WCAG 2.1 non text contrast requirements](#) and use [ADA checker](#) to verify specific use cases.

Best Practices: Graphic Elements*

Graphic elements that do not communicate meaning essential to the information being conveyed and are used for visual interest or embellishment only, do not have to adhere to a specific contrast requirement. However, it is always preferable that any interface elements have good visibility for all audiences.



*NOTE: examples shown do not represent all possible color combinations.
Please see [WCAG 2.1 non text contrast requirements](#) and use [ADA checker](#) to verify specific use cases.

Best Practices: Logos*

Logos do not have a contrast requirement



*NOTE: examples shown do not represent all possible color combinations.

Please see [WCAG 2.1 non text contrast requirements](#) and use [ADA checker](#) to verify specific use cases.

Thank You